

CROCHET PATTERN · AMIGURUMI

DESIGN CODE NS 04

Coco the Capybara

US crochet terms · Intermediate · 2.5–3 hours

A low, round, bottom-heavy capybara with a blunt sewn-on muzzle, plump stuffed legs and a calm embroidered sleeping face. The face is embroidered, so there are no safety eyes and no small plastic parts.

Coco stands on all four legs and measures about 10.3 cm (4 in) tall and 5 cm (2 in) wide.

Design code	NS 04	Hook	3.0 mm (US C-2 or D-3)
Skill level	Intermediate	Eyes	None — embroidered
Time	2.5–3 hours	Yarn	Worsted weight (#4)
Finished size	10.3 cm tall × 5 cm wide	Parts	4 legs · 2 ears · 1 muzzle

Verified before publishing: design code **NS 04** matches the source file, and the byline reads **Novality Crochet Studio** (the pattern's own terms of use credit *Novality Store*). Stitch counts and measurements were checked round by round — see the notes in Gauge and Finished Size.

THE FINISHED COCO



Finished Coco — worked in warm brown worsted weight on a 3.0 mm hook. About 10.3 cm (4 in) tall and 5 cm (2 in) wide, standing on all four legs.

SKILL LEVEL

Every round in this pattern is beginner-level: magic ring, single crochet, increase and invisible decrease.

The one step that is not beginner-level is the **two-layer leg join** at Rnd 4 and Rnd 5, where you crochet a finished leg and the body together in a single stitch. It is explained in full in technique 3, and it is worth practicing once on a scrap magic ring before you start the body.

MATERIALS

Main yarn — Worsted weight (#4), warm brown, about 30 g. A smooth matte yarn shows the stitch texture best.

Face yarn — Worsted weight (#4), dark brown, about 5 g, for the closed eyes, nose and mouth. Use the same weight as the main yarn; a lighter yarn changes how the embroidery sits on the face.

Hook — **3.0 mm (US C-2 or D-3)**. The gauge below is written for this hook.

Eyes — None. The sleeping face is embroidered.

Also needed — Polyester fiber filling, about 5–8 g; yarn needle; stitch marker; pins. Pins matter here — the muzzle and the ears are pinned in place before they are sewn.

Safety. Coco has no safety eyes and no small plastic parts, which makes the face safer than a safety-eyed toy. That does not make the finished toy suitable for babies. Coco is a stuffed toy with a sewn-on muzzle and sewn-on ears, and it has not been tested to a toy-safety standard such as ASTM F963 or EN 71. Intended as a decorative item, or a gift for a child old enough not to chew it. Check the seams before giving Coco to a young child.

GAUGE

Worked on a 3.0 mm hook and stuffed: **36 single crochet around measures about 52 mm in diameter**. That is 4.5 mm per stitch and 4.3 mm per round.

Check your gauge on the body after Rnd 6 rather than on a flat swatch. A stuffed tube is the only honest test for amigurumi, and it is the measurement every dimension in this pattern depends on.

If your 36 stitches measure wider than 52 mm, your tension is loose — crochet more tightly, or go down a hook size. Coco at a loose gauge will show her stuffing.

FINISHED SIZE

About **10.3 cm (4 in) tall** standing on all four legs, and **5 cm (2 in) wide** at the widest part of the body.

Coco is meant to be squat and bottom-heavy. Her legs are short relative to the round body, and the body is one continuous curve from base to crown.

The height is the body plus the legs:

Body, Rnd 1 to Rnd 20	20 rnd × 4.3 mm = 86 mm
Front legs	9 rnd × 4.3 mm = 38.7 mm
Back legs	8 rnd × 4.3 mm = 34.4 mm
Height the legs lift the body off the table	17 mm
Total standing height	86 + 17 = 103 mm (10.3 cm)

Both pairs hang the same distance below the body: the back legs are 34.4 mm long and join 17 mm up ($34.4 - 17 = 17.4$ mm of leg below), the front legs are 38.7 mm long and join 21.5 mm up ($38.7 - 21.5 = 17.2$ mm). That is why the front legs need the extra round.

ABBREVIATIONS

MR	magic ring
ch	chain
sc	single crochet
inc	increase — 2 sc in one stitch
invdec	invisible decrease
sl st	slip stitch
st(s)	stitch(es)
Rnd(s)	round(s)
FO	fasten off
(n)	the stitch count at the end of that round

WORKING NOTES

Work in **continuous spiral rounds**. Do not join at the end of a round and do not chain 1 between rounds. Move a stitch marker into the first stitch of every round — in a spiral there is no join to count from, and the marker is the only way to know where a round ends.

Unless a note says otherwise, work every stitch through both loops.

HOW IT COMES TOGETHER

The three techniques used throughout this pattern, in the order you meet them.

1 · The magic ring

Every piece begins with a magic ring. Pull the tail tight once the first round is complete.

2 · Working in a spiral

Keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round. There is no seam and no join to count from.

3 · The two-layer leg join

This is the only genuinely fiddly step in the pattern.

Hold a finished leg against the body, with the pinched-flat top of the leg lying against the outside of the body. Insert your hook through **both** the leg and the body stitch, and work one single crochet. The leg edge and the body stitch are treated as a single stitch.

Those stitches still count as one stitch each, so every stitch count in the body table stays correct.

Pinching the leg top flat first is what makes this easy. A round, un-pinched leg top will not lie flat against the curved body, and the join will pucker.

PART 1 — LEGS, EARS AND MUZZLE

Make these first. The legs are stuffed — plump little balls that the body rests on.

Leg

Make 2 back legs (8 rounds) and 2 front legs (9 rounds).

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	WHICH LEGS
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	all four
R2	[1 sc, inc] ×3	(9)	all four
R3	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R4	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R5	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R6	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R7	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R8	sc in each st around	(9)	all four — back legs finish here
R9	sc in each st around	(9)	front legs only

Finish. Stuff the lower half of each leg lightly, leaving the top loose.

Then **pinch the whole 9-stitch top flat into a narrow strip about 3 stitches wide**. Press it between finger and thumb and hold it that way while you work the join. FO with a long tail for sewing.

The back legs stop after Rnd 8 (about 34 mm). The front legs work Rnd 9 as well (about 39 mm). The front legs are the longer pair on purpose: they join the body one round higher up, so they need to be one round longer for all four feet to reach the table at the same height. Make all four legs the same length and Coco will rock back onto her haunches with her front feet in the air.

The leg top is 9 stitches around, so a flattened edge is naturally about 5 stitches across. Pinching it down to 3 is deliberate. The stitches you do not join bunch up inside the join, and that bunch is what makes the leg look plump rather than tubular. Do not try to keep the top flat and wide — it will not sit against the curved body.

Ear — make 2

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)
R2	[1 sc, inc] ×3	(9)
R3	sc in each st around	(9)

Finish. FO with a long tail. Do not stuff. Each finished ear is a shallow cup about 20 mm across and 13 mm tall.

Muzzle — make 1

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)
R2	[1 sc, inc] ×3	(9)
R3	[2 sc, inc] ×3	(12)
R4	sc in each st around	(12)
R5	sc in each st around	(12)

Finish. FO with a long tail. Stuff lightly, just enough to hold a dome. The finished muzzle is about 17 mm across.

PART 2 — BODY AND HEAD

Body and head are worked as one piece, bottom up. Both are 36 stitches around, with only a shallow waist between them — that is what makes Coco read as one continuous round blob rather than a snowman.

The legs are joined low, at Rnd 4 and Rnd 5, while the base is still curving outward.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[1 sc, inc] ×6	(18)	
R4	3 sc, [1 sc, inc] ×3, 3 sc, [1 sc, inc] ×3	(24)	join the BACK legs
R5	[3 sc, inc] ×6	(30)	join the FRONT legs
R6	[4 sc, inc] ×6	(36)	body at full width — check gauge here
R7	sc in each st around	(36)	
R8	sc in each st around	(36)	
R9	sc in each st around	(36)	stuff the body FIRMLY
R10	[7 sc, invdec] ×4	(32)	shallow waist
R11	[7 sc, inc] ×4	(36)	head begins
R12	sc in each st around	(36)	
R13	sc in each st around	(36)	
R14	sc in each st around	(36)	
R15	sc in each st around	(36)	
R16	[4 sc, invdec] ×6	(30)	
R17	[3 sc, invdec] ×6	(24)	stuff the head firmly
R18	[2 sc, invdec] ×6	(18)	
R19	[1 sc, invdec] ×6	(12)	top up the stuffing
R20	invdec ×6	(6)	

Finish. Cinch the remaining 6 stitches closed and weave the tail inside the body.

Joining the legs

Work Rnd 4 and Rnd 5 as the plain increase rounds printed in the table above, but as you reach each leg position, hold a pinched-flat leg top against the body and work the next 3 sc through both the leg and the body together (technique 3). Those 3 sc still count as 3 stitches of the round, so the stitch counts do not change.

Rnd 4 — the back legs

Work the first **3 sc** through a leg and the body together, then **[1 sc, inc] ×3**.

Work the next **3 sc** through the second leg and the body together, then **[1 sc, inc] ×3** to the end of the round.

Total 24 stitches.

Rnd 5 — the front legs

Work **7 sc**.

Join a leg over the next **3 sc**.

Work **10 sc**.

Join a leg over the next **3 sc**.

Work **7 sc** to the end of the round.

Total 30 stitches.

The 7 – 10 – 7 spacing is what keeps Coco steady. It centers each front leg between the two back legs, so her four feet cover the deepest footprint this shape allows — about 65 mm across and 29 mm from front to back.

Work the numbers exactly as printed. If the front legs end up directly behind the back legs instead of between them, Coco's footprint narrows to about 9 mm from front to back and she will tip over forwards and backwards.

Hold the piece upside down and check that all four legs sit square before you stuff the body.

PART 3 — WHY THE LEGS JOIN SO LOW

The back legs are 8 rounds long, about 34 mm, and they join at Rnd 4 — only 17 mm above the base of the body. The front legs are 9 rounds long, about 39 mm, and they join at Rnd 5, 21 mm up.

Different lengths, same result: **every foot hangs 17 mm below the body**, so all four land level and the underside of the body clears the table by about that much. Coco stands on her feet, not on her belly.

This is the single most common failure on a round-bodied animal. Legs joined at the widest part of the body are always too high: the belly rests on the table and the feet dangle in the air.

If Coco does not stand, check the join height before anything else.

PART 4 — FACE AND ASSEMBLY

Muzzle

Stuff the muzzle lightly and pin it to the front of the head over **Rnd 12–14**, centered on the face. Sew all the way around with matching brown.

The muzzle should sit proud of the head, not flush with it.

Centering matters. The muzzle is about 17 mm across and the eyes go 27 mm apart, which leaves only about 5 mm of clear face between the edge of the muzzle and each eye. A muzzle pinned even slightly off-center will crowd one eye.

Eyes

Embroider the eyes — do not use safety eyes.

With dark brown, work a shallow downward arc about 3 stitches wide on each side, at **Rnd 14–15, 6 stitches apart**, with a tiny tick angled down at each outer end.

Six stitches keeps both eyes on the front of the face. Any wider and they wrap around the sides. Placing them at Rnd 14–15 keeps the whole eye above the muzzle, which is pinned over Rnd 12–14.

This closed-eye curve is what makes Coco look asleep.

Nose and mouth

Embroider the nose and mouth **after** the muzzle is sewn on, so the stitches sit on the finished curve rather than on a flat piece.

On the muzzle, work a small dark triangle at the top center, then a short vertical line down from it, and a soft curved mouth to one side.

Ears

Pinch the base of each ear so it cups forward, then sew at **Rnd 15**, about **5 stitches apart**, angled slightly outward.

Rnd 15 is still a full 36-stitch round, so 5 stitches puts the ears on top of the head where a capybara's ears belong. Sewing them wider apart — or onto Rnd 16, which has already decreased to 30 stitches — pushes them out to the sides of the head, where they disappear from the front.

Legs

The legs were joined during Rnd 4 and Rnd 5. There is nothing to sew. Just check that the pinched 3-stitch strip of each leg is caught fully in the round.

Final shaping

Roll the finished piece gently between your palms to settle the stuffing into a round, bottom-heavy shape.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Coco looks too tall

Almost always too many plain rounds. Rnd 12–15 is the straight section of the head, and the face is positioned on it. Adding “just one more” round each time turns the shape into a tower and moves the face off the round it was designed for.

Coco will not stand

Check the join height, not the leg spacing. The legs belong on Rnd 4 and Rnd 5. Joined any higher, they cannot clear the underside of the body.

Coco tips forward or backward

Two causes, in order of likelihood. First, the front legs are lined up behind the back legs instead of between them: the Rnd 5 spacing must be 7 sc, 10 sc, 7 sc. Second, Coco is deliberately narrow from front to back, at about 29 mm, and no leg spacing changes that. If she still tips, stuff the lower body more firmly and settle her weight back over all four feet.

Coco rocks back onto her haunches, front feet in the air

All four legs are the same length, and they cannot be. The front legs join at Rnd 5, 21 mm up, and the back legs at Rnd 4, 17 mm up, so equal-length legs leave the back feet about 9 mm lower. Work the front legs 9 rounds and the back legs 8.

Coco will not sit level

Stuff the lower body firmly. A soft base lets Coco tip forward onto her muzzle.

The head flops back

The waist at Rnd 10 is deliberately shallow, at 32 stitches. Do not decrease it further. A narrow neck cannot hold the head upright on this shape.

The muzzle looks flat

Stuff it just enough to hold a dome.

Stuffing shows through

Your gauge is too loose. Thirty-six stitches should measure 52 mm around a stuffed body. Crochet more tightly, or go down a hook size.

There is a small hole where a leg meets the body

You joined a flat, wide leg top instead of a pinched one. Flatten the whole 9-stitch top into a strip about 3 stitches wide before joining, so the stitches you are not joining bunch up inside the join.

COLORWAYS

Classic warm brown, soft grey, sandy beige, and cocoa.

BEFORE YOU ASSEMBLE

Lay every component out and check it against the pattern before you sew anything:

- 4 legs — 2 back legs of 8 rounds, 2 front legs of 9 rounds
- 2 ears
- 1 muzzle
- 1 body and head, closed at the crown

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